

CAPUCHIN FATHERS

ST. BONAVENTURE MONASTERY

1740 MT. ELLIOTT AVENUE

DETROIT, MICH. July 16, 1937

Mrs. Margaret LeDoux
Oakland California

My Dear Sister Margaret:-

God bless you and yours. I hope you are feeling better this beautiful feast of Mt. Carmel-and of our Blessed Mother-than when you wrote that letter of the 11th. Sure some letter! I had planned on answering a letter of our new Archbishop this morning, but found it hard to finish reading yours before starting an answer.

After reading on I found it took a brighter turn and I quite enjoyed it. However, dear Margaret, I see that you are just another piece of humanity like myself and like I meet with every hour of the day - inclined to worry and fret about the morrow as though Our Dear Lord had never spoken a word about His divine providence or proved His loving solicitude for each of us a thousand times a day. Just think back a little and be convinced with me that our biggest worries are almost invariably about things that have never happened. For my part I've long been convinced that these worries - mostly about phantoms of some kind - must/ a big source of toll for the enemy of salvation. How easily we forget the beautiful words of Our Dear Lord' in His sermon on the mount; -- "Blessed are the poor in spirit...etc" as in Matt. V & VI. The conclusion of all, after calling attention to the bird of the air and the flowers of the field, etc: "Be not solicitous for the morrow for the morrow will be solicitus for itself". I sometimes think we make a great blunder in the fact that, instead of thanking God for His goodness and kindness on every side and making acts of confidence in His loving providence, we just act as though everything depended on luck or on fortune etc. Is it not true? And what a mistake! One of our best promoters of mission work - a certain Miss McEvily - became enemic about five years ago and had to go the state hospital at Eloise Michigan. She lamented the fact most especially that she could receive now only once a week. When I wrote back and asked her if she would swap places and chances with poor Henry Ford, with all his billions, she seemed disposed to appreciate more than ever something of the wealth of her faith.